Parent's Guide to Coding

How to pick a first language and support your child at home

You don't need to know how to code to help your child learn it. This short guide explains where to start, how to support practice at home, and what good progress looks like.

1. WHERE SHOULD MY CHILD START?	
Ages 6-9	**Scratch or Code.org.** Drag-and-drop blocks, no typing. Children build animations and simple games and learn the logic of coding: sequences, loops and decisions.
Ages 10-12	**Scratch (advanced), Thunkable or beginner Python.** Thunkable builds real phone apps with blocks. Python is a good first typed language once typing is comfortable.
Ages 13+	**Python, web development (HTML, CSS, JavaScript) or AI projects.** Teens can start building websites, bots and tools they actually use.
Never coded?	Start with blocks, whatever the age. Moving to typed code later is much easier once the thinking is in place.

2. HOW TO SUPPORT PRACTICE AT HOME	
Little and often	20-30 minutes, 3-4 times a week works better than one long session.
Ask, don't tell	Try: "What does this part do?" or "What do you think will happen if you change that number?" Let them find the answer.
Celebrate bugs	Every programmer's code breaks. Say "great, a puzzle!" instead of fixing it for them. Debugging is a core skill.
Show it off	Ask for a demo at dinner. Presenting their project builds confidence and communication skills.
Keep it theirs	Let them pick the theme: a game about their pet, a quiz about their favourite sport. Interest keeps them going.

3. FIVE QUESTIONS TO ASK AFTER EVERY CLASS	
1	What did you make or change today?
2	What was the trickiest part, and how did you get past it?
3	Can you show me how it works?
4	What would you add if you had more time?
5	What are you most proud of?

4. WHAT GOOD PROGRESS LOOKS LIKE	
First few weeks	Gets comfortable with the tool, completes small guided projects, starts explaining what blocks or lines do.
After a few months	Finishes projects with less help, fixes some bugs alone, starts adding their own ideas.
Longer term	Plans a project before building it, breaks big problems into small steps, and chooses to build things for fun.
Remember	Every child moves at their own pace. Progress is steady curiosity and growing confidence, not speed.

5. SAFE AND HEALTHY CODING TIME	
Share safely	Don't use full names, school names or photos in public projects. Use a nickname on online communities.
Account sign-ups	Most coding sites require a parent's email for children under 13. Please create or approve accounts together.
Screen breaks	Pause every 30-45 minutes. Stretch, drink water, look at something far away.
Offline coding	Plan a game on paper first, or act out a loop: "jump 5 times, then spin". Sketching ideas first saves time on screen.

6. FREE TOOLS TO TRY AT HOME	
scratch.mit.edu	Block coding for ages 6+. Free; make an account to save projects.
code.org	Hour of Code activities and courses for beginners, free.
thunkable.com	Build phone apps with blocks. Free plan available.
trinket.io / replit.com	Write Python in the browser, nothing to install.

Not sure which class fits? Book a free demo.

A 1:1 live class with a teacher is the quickest way to see if your child enjoys coding. We'll recommend a starting course based on their age and interests.

Email: infibeecoders@gmail.com **Tell us:** child's name, age and preferred timings.